

Hebrews 1-6

Oct 30-Nov 5

Bible dictionary - Pauline Epistles

- this is what it says for the letter to the Hebrews
 - this epistle was written to Jewish members of the church
 - to persuade them that significant aspects of the law of Moses - as a forerunner
 - had been fulfilled in Christ
 - and that the higher gospel law of Christ had replaced it
 - Paul wrote the epistle to the Hebrews to show them by their own scriptures
 - and by sound reason
 - why they should no longer practice the law of Moses

Time-period, context, Temple

- regardless of who wrote it by 90 A.D. - even before the 2nd Century - there were early Christians that were quoting this
 - so it is a first century Christian document
- it's written to individuals who are coming out of Judaism and into Christianity and they're really struggling
- one of their struggles is do I go back to my Jewish faith
 - do I trust in the 613 laws of Torah and living the law
 - or do I trust or have faith in Jesus
- and that temptation to go back I think is something that everyone faces at some point when they're a convert
- and at times they may have doubts and be thinking:
 - did I make the right decision
 - is this really what I need to be doing
- because of that the author of Hebrews is going to be making the argument that
 - Jesus is the right answer
 - Jesus is the way
 - and his way is better
- 70 AD - the temple was destroyed which really caused a lot of Jews to have great questions or perhaps even doubts
 - wondering is God With Us
- this document is highlighting things like
 - the knowledge of the Holy priesthood
 - Christ's status as a high priest
 - and the messenger of our profession or our Proclamation
 - that he is who he says he is
 - that God swore an oath that his son would be a priest Forever After the order of Melchizedek
 - we find hints towards the oath and Covenant of the priesthood in here
 - and we also find great statements as to who Jesus is way back in the pre-earth life
 - it ties us into who Jesus is and also shows us that Jesus is going to take us into the rest of God which rest according to the doctrine covenants is the fullness of his glory
 - and in the seventh chapter which Melchizedek now in the first Israelite Temple from when the temple was constructed during the monarchy around 1,000 BC to its

Let go of the old and embrace the new

- now I know we've talked about this in previous Epistles because this is a major theme coming out of the New Testament
- but this is where it comes kind of to culmination
- the idea that members of the church - Jewish members of the church - can't let go of the law of Moses
- they can't fully embrace all that Christ offered because they're so tied to the law of Moses
- is a major theme not just of their day but of our day
- because the invitation is to let go of old things
 - let go of telestial and terrestrial things
 - and move into the Celestial Kingdom
- let go of the old and come into the father's presence
 - come into the holy place
 - come into the celestial room
- but some of us are still holding on to lesser things
 - we're holding on to telestial things that are keeping us out of the temple itself
 - and then we hold on to terrestrial things that are keeping us out of the father's presence
- this is a very applicable idea that's taught throughout the New Testament but really emphasized here in the letter to the Hebrews
 - let go of the old and embrace the new

1. The New Covenant is better

- ch1 v4 - being made so much **better** than the angels He hath by inheritance obtained a **more excellent** Name than they
- ch3 v3 - that he is an apostle and high priest of our profession Christ Jesus
for this man was counted **worthy of more** Glory than Moses
insomuch as he who hath builded the house hath **more honor**
than the house
- ch4 v1,3,4,5,8,9,10,11 - **rest**
 - Christ offers a **better** rest than the Children of Israel were offered.
- ch5 v1-3 - Christ is a **better** High Priest
- jumping to the pivotal ch7 v7 - speaking of melchizedek
priesthood vs aaronic priesthood - or melchizedek vs Levi -
“superiority”
 - he says that Levi the less is blessed of the **better**
 - so clearly melchizedek and the melchizedek priesthood and the ordinances of the melchizedek priesthood **are better than** the ordinances offered by the aaronic priesthood
- ch7 v19 - the law made nothing perfect but the bringing in of a **better hope**
 - no one had a great hope in the law of Moses but Jesus has brought a **better hope**
- ch7 v22 - Jesus made a surety of a **better** testament
- ch8 v6 - but now hath he obtained **a more excellent** Ministry
by how much also he is the mediator of a **better** Covenant
which was established upon **better** promises
 - why are you holding on to the Lesser when Jesus has brought a better Covenant
 - so a more excellent Ministry with a better Covenant and better promises
- ch9 v11 - a **greater and more perfect** tabernacle, not made with hands
 - He's a better tabernacle because he's the real thing - not just the symbol of it
- ch9 v12,13,14 - the law of Moses was full of sacrifices and the blood of bulls and goats, but the law of Christ is full of **better blood**
- ch9 v23 - it was therefore necessary that the patterns of things in the heavens should be purified with these but the Heavenly things themselves with **better** sacrifices than these
- ch10 v1 - Christ is the giver of a **better law**
- ch10 34 - and for ye had compassion of me in my bonds and took joyfully the spoiling of your goods knowing in yourselves that ye have in heaven a **better and more enduring substance**
 - v35 - Cast not away therefore your confidence, which hath great recompense of reward
 - in other words the vision that Christ gives us the hope for the future the message of the modern gospel that Jesus delivered in his day
 - gives us a greater and a better hope of the blessings in heaven
- ch11 - this chapter is like a **Hall of Fame** for the old testament - Able, Enoch, Noah, Abraham & Sara, Jacob, Joseph, Moses, Gedeon, Samson, David, Samuel,
 - **v13** - ... confessed that they were strangers and pilgrims on the earth... they seek a country.
- ch11 v16 - but now they desire a **better country** that is an Heavenly - for those that follow Him
- ch11 v35 - that they might obtain a **better resurrection**
- ch11 v40 - God having provided some **better things** for us - let go of the old -
 - JST Heb. 11:40 God having provided some better things for them through their sufferings, for without sufferings they could not be made perfect.
- ch12 v16,17 - Christ extends to us a **better birthright**
- ch13 v9,10,11 - Christ makes it possible to worship at a **better altar**

2. Because the Covenant of Christ is ***better*** than the law of Moses, we need to be better

- ch2 v1-3 - "let us" ... give the more earnest heed to the things which we have heard
- ch3 v8-11 - "let us" ... not harden our hearts
- ch3 v17-19 - "let us" ... not have our carcasses fall in the wilderness because of unbelief
- ch4 v1 - "let us" ... act carefully so we don't miss out on his rest
- ch4 v11 - "let us" ... labor therefore (work hard) to enter into that rest
- ch4 v14 - "let us" ... hold fast to our profession (of faith)
- ch4 v16 - "let us" ... therefore come boldly unto the throne of grace that we may obtain mercy and find Grace to help in time of need
- ch6 v1,9 - "let us" ... go on unto perfection
- ch10 v22 - "let us" ... draw near with a True Heart in full assurance of Faith
- ch10 v23 - "let us" ... hold fast the profession of our faith without wavering
- ch10 v24 - "let us" ... assemble ourselves together
"let us" ... provoke each other unto love and to Good Works
- ch12 v1 - "let us" ... lay aside the weight of sin
"let us" ... run with patience the race (of life) that is set before us
"let us" ... look unto Jesus as an example
- ch12 v14 - "let us" ... serve our fellow man
- ch12 v28 - "let us" ... have Grace (gratitude) whereby we may serve God acceptably with reverence and godly fear
- ch13 v13 - "let us" ... go forth therefore unto him (leave the world to follow Christ)
- ch13 v15 - "let us" ... praise God continually ... giving thanks to his name

3. Why is it better?

- now the third theme which in my opinion makes the epistle to the Hebrews such a wonderful study is
 - why is it better
- and it's a study of what Jesus accomplished
 - this epistle is trying to show you the Excellence of what Jesus did
 - what did he do that makes the gospel that he presented to us so much better
 - we get some wonderful little insights into Christ
- let me just give you a couple of them
 - in chapter 4 - for we have not an high priest which cannot be touched with the feeling of our infirmities but was in all points tempted like as we are yet without sin
 - that's what he did
 - and that's why his gospel is so much better
 - he knows
 - he understands
 - Jesus understands The Human Condition so much better than Moses did or that anyone did
 - so why hold to the law of Moses when we have so much better high priest who was touched with the feeling of our infirmities
- just one more related to that chapter five - though he were a son yet he learned obedience by the things which he suffered and being made perfect he became the author of Eternal salvation unto all them that obey him
- Hebrews is an invitation to come to really know what Jesus accomplished